Krystal Gutierrez

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin, Austin, TX May 2027

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

***Relevant Coursework*:** Data Structures, Computer Architecture, Operating Systems, Object Oriented Programming, Game Programming Paradigms

Honors & Awards: 2024, 2025 & 2026 Hispanic Scholarship Fund Scholar

SKILLS

Technical Skills: *C++, C#, Java, Python, Lua, Unreal Engine, Unity, Linux, Git, GitHub, GitLab*

Languages: *Fluent English, Intermediate Spanish*

EXPERIENCE

Texas Advanced Computing Center (TACC), Austin, TX March 2025 - Present

Software Engineer/Undergraduate Research Assistant

- Designed and developed a cooperative Unity game where players collaboratively manage a restaurant, integrating core CS concepts to reinforce computational thinking through gameplay.
- Implemented multiplayer networking with FishNet: Networking Evolved, including player synchronization, shared game state, cross-client mechanics, and Linux-based server hosting.
- Developed and integrated gameplay features in Unity, including interactive restaurant mechanics, animations, 3D assets, UI elements, and player feedback systems.
- Managed GitHub and GitLab repositories, resolving merge conflicts, reviewing contributions, and tracking issues to support collaborative development.

PROJECTS

ENSOUL | Unity (C#) August 2026 – Present

Programmer & Marketing Master

- Developing a rhythm/JRPG game in a multidisciplinary team, contributing to both gameplay programming and product/market strategy.
- Lead audience and market research to identify target player demographics, genre preferences, competing games, and platform opportunities to inform the team's positioning and go-to-market strategy.
- Translate player and market insights into recommendations for game positioning, audience targeting, and promotional strategy.
- Develop core gameplay systems including overworld exploration, character movement, inventory, party management, items, and encounter transitions between overworld and combat.
- Collaborate with programmers, artists, designers, and other team members to align gameplay development with the intended player experience and target audience.

Maxwell's Dream Diary | Unreal Engine 5 (C++) November 2025 - December 2025

- Developed a 3D horror game in Unreal Engine 5, collaborating on game design, mechanics, and narrative while implementing core player systems in C++.
- Programmed the character movement system in C++, including tank-style controls, walking, sprinting, crouching, and movement behavior across fixed-camera perspectives.
- Implemented a fixed-camera system inspired by classic survival horror games, integrating camera transitions with player movement and exploration.
- Configured player interactions for doors and collectible diary pages using Unreal's interactable base classes and input bindings.
- Implemented sprint and stamina mechanics with a dynamic UI stamina bar.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Electronic Game Developers Society (EGaDS!) September 2023 - Present

Community and Socials JO → Outreach and Recruitment Officer → Main Events Officer → Co-President

- Lead the organization as Co-President, directing the officer team, organizing and leading weekly officer meetings, delegating responsibilities, and overseeing event planning, industry collaborations, outreach, and organization-wide initiatives.
- Organized and promoted the largest Texas Game Jam (TxGJ) in EGaDS! history, drawing 400+ participants and 80 game submissions.